Flora Case Study

Faiza Khan

Google

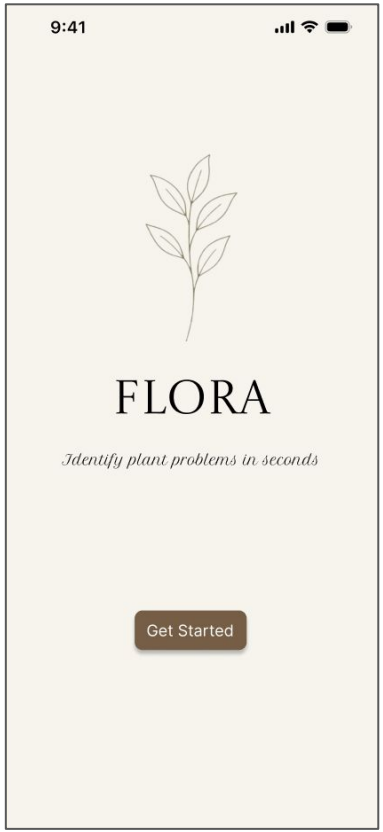
Project Overview

The product:

A mobile app and responsive website that helps users diagnose issues with their houseplants and receive care recommendations. The target users are beginner and intermediate plant owners.

Project duration:

Feb - March 2026



Project overview

The problem:

Many plant owners struggle to identify what is wrong with their houseplants when they show signs of damage or poor health, making it difficult to provide the proper care.

The goal:

The goal of this app is to help users quickly diagnose issues with their houseplants and provide clear guidance on how to care for them so their plants can stay healthy and thrive.

Project overview

My role:

Lead UX/UI Designer

Responsibilities:

- Created user personas and defined user goals
- Designed wireframes and high-fidelity mockups for the app
- Developed interactive prototypes to demonstrate the user flow
- Refined the interface to improve usability and user experience

Google

Understanding the user

- Personas
- Problem Statements
- User journey maps

Persona: Elena Cruz

Problem statement:

Elena Cruz is a busy managing director and plant owner who needs a quick and reliable way to diagnose problems with her plants because she doesn't have enough time to research plant care while managing her daily responsibilities.

Name: Elena Cruz

Age: 33
Education: Bachelors in Business
Hometown: New York
Family: Lives alone
Occupation: Managing Director

"Success is my standard."

Goals

- To have a simple, reliable system that quickly identifies what's wrong with her plants

Frustrations

- Never having enough time to research plant problems between responsibilities

She starts her mornings with intention — a quick workout, a quiet moment — because balance and well-being matter to her. She wants a life that feels full, not just busy. But as the day goes on, notifications, errands, and small daily tasks pile up. By night, she realizes she hasn't had a moment to breathe. Her biggest frustration isn't work — it's never having enough time for herself. She wants simple systems that make daily life smoother and help her feel back in control.

Google

Persona: Alejandro Ramirez

Problem statement:

Alejandro Ramirez is a busy IT support specialist and plant owner who needs a simple, reliable way to diagnose plant issues because his daily responsibilities leave him with little time and mental energy to figure out why his plants are declining

Name: Alejandro Ramirez

Age: 25
Education: Bachelors in IT
Hometown: Toronto
Family: Lives with his pet dog Milo
Occupation: IT Support Specialist

"Small steps every day turn into big results."

Goals

- To steadily learn how to care for plants the same way he's growing his tech skills, through small, consistent wins that build real confidence over time.

Frustrations

- Daily responsibilities piling up and leaving no mental energy to properly diagnose why his plants keep declining.

Alejandro starts his mornings feeding Milo before heading to work. His job is steady, but by the end of the day, he feels low on energy. He wants to save money, stay fit, and grow professionally, but daily responsibilities often take over. He's looking for simple systems that help him stay organized and make progress without feeling overwhelmed.

Google

User journey map

Elena values efficiency and simplicity because her schedule is busy and demanding. She wants a quick and reliable way to diagnose plant problems without spending time researching. The app should provide fast, easy-to-understand solutions that fit into her daily routine.

Persona: Elena Cruz

Goal: *To have a simple, reliable system that quickly identifies what's wrong with her plants*

ACTION	Morning workout	Work and Meetings	Managing Notifications and Tasks	Evening Wind-Down	Reflection and Planning
TASK LIST	Tasks A. Short workout B. Quiet time / writing C. Look over today's to-do list	Tasks A. Run team meetings B. Make big decisions C. Reply to emails & urgent messages	Tasks A. Check and reply to notifications B. Run errands C. Get through small daily tasks	Tasks A. Finish missed tasks B. Try to relax C. Get ready for the next day	Tasks A. Look back at what got done B. Plan for tomorrow C. Try to find time for herself
FEELING ADJECTIVE	Motivated and intentional	Focused	Overwhelmed	Exhausted	Hopeful
IMPROVEMENT OPPORTUNITIES	A quick plant check-in tool she can use in 60 seconds before her day starts	Instant photo-based diagnosis so she's not Googling symptoms between meetings	Push alerts that flag plant issues before they get worse, so it's one less thing to worry about	A simple care summary; what needs water, what needs attention, so she feels on top of it	A weekly plant health overview that shows progress and builds her confidence over time

Google

User journey map

Alejandro values simplicity and consistency because his daily routine is busy and often draining. He needs a quick, reliable way to diagnose plant issues without spending extra time researching. The app should offer fast, easy-to-follow solutions that fit seamlessly into his routine and help him make steady progress with minimal effort.

Persona: Alejandro Ramirez

Goal: *To steadily learn how to care for plants the same way he's growing his tech skills, through small, consistent wins that build real confidence over time.*

ACTION	Morning routine	Work	Post Work	Evening Learning and Fitness	Night
TASK LIST	Tasks A. Feed Milo B. Commute to work C. Check schedule for the day	Tasks A. Work through IT tickets B. Fix tech problems C. Help coworkers with their devices	Tasks A. Feel too tired to do anything B. Skip things he planned to do C. Snack and zone out	Tasks A. Try an online lesson B. Do a quick workout C. Check savings	Tasks A. Scroll through social media B. Compare himself to others C. Have trouble going to sleep
FEELING ADJECTIVE	Calm but rushed	Busy	Lazy	Inconsistent	Anxious
IMPROVEMENT OPPORTUNITIES	A quick checklist tied to his plants so he knows what needs attention before he leaves	Saved diagnoses he can come back to after work without losing track	A simple 2-minute plant check that gives him an easy win when energy is low	Bite-sized plant care tips that build his knowledge the same way he learns tech skills	A care log that shows his plants improving over time, countering the anxiety of feeling like he's failing

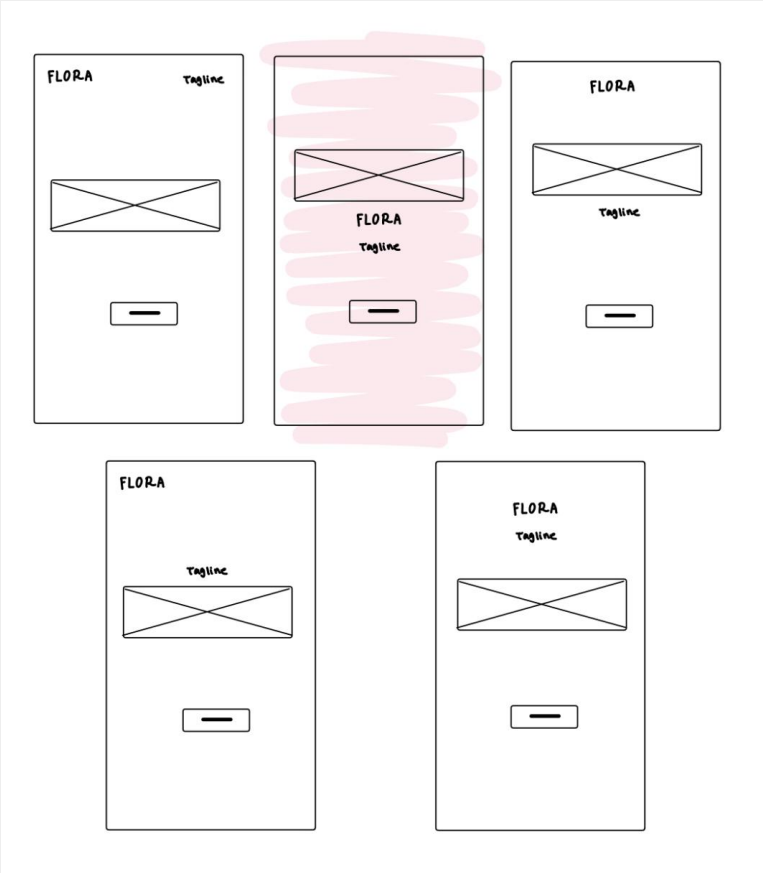
Google

Starting the design

- Paper wireframes
- Digital wireframes
- Low-fidelity prototype

Paper wireframes

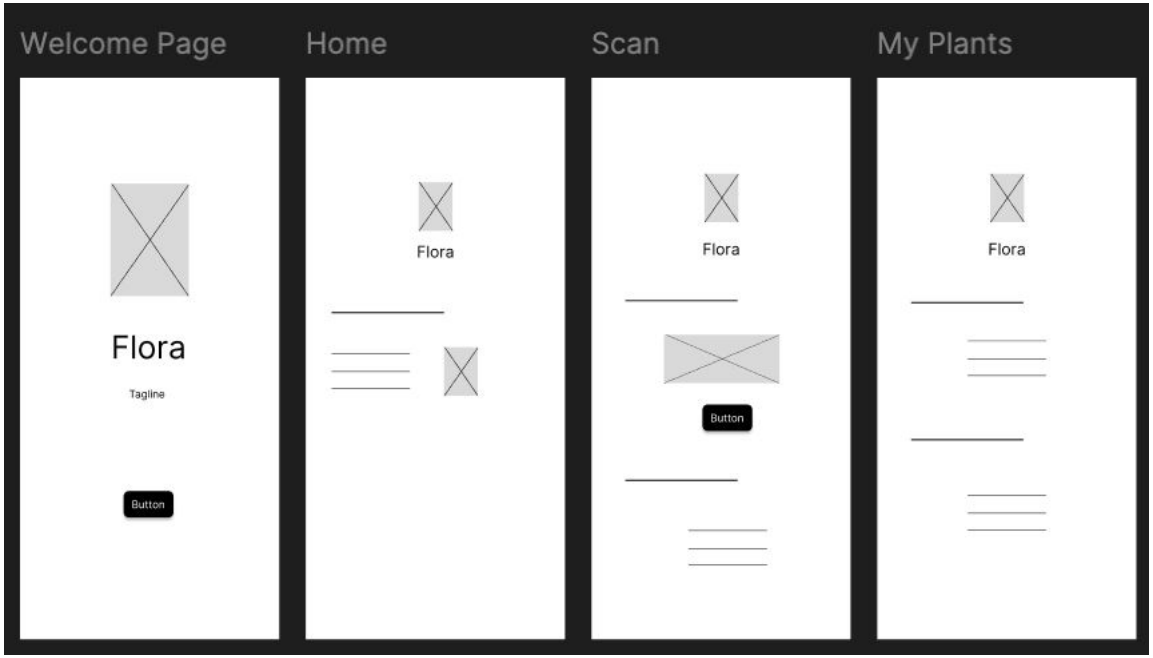
These five wireframes explore different layout arrangements for Flora's landing screen. Testing logo placement, tagline positioning, and CTA button alignment. The highlighted center frame was selected as the preferred direction for its clean, centered hierarchy.



Google

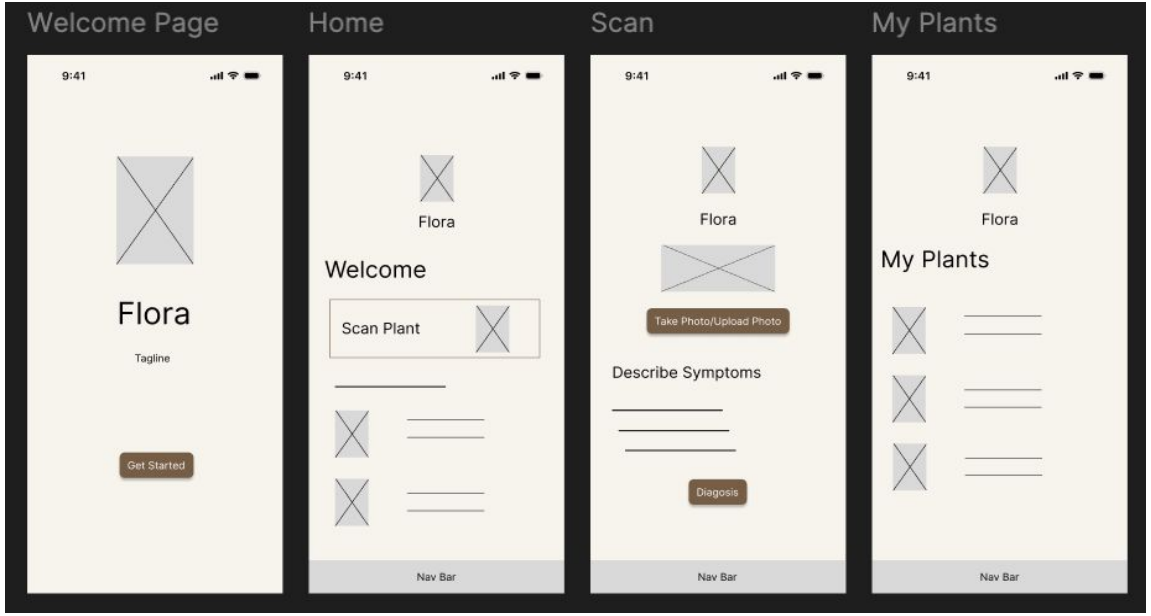
Digital wireframes

After choosing the best layout from the paper sketches, I recreated it digitally to get a cleaner, more accurate view of how the final screens would look before adding colours and visuals.



Low-fidelity prototype

The wireframe was brought to life by adding colour and styling; a warm off-white background, earthy brown button, and refined typography to give Flora a natural, calm feel.

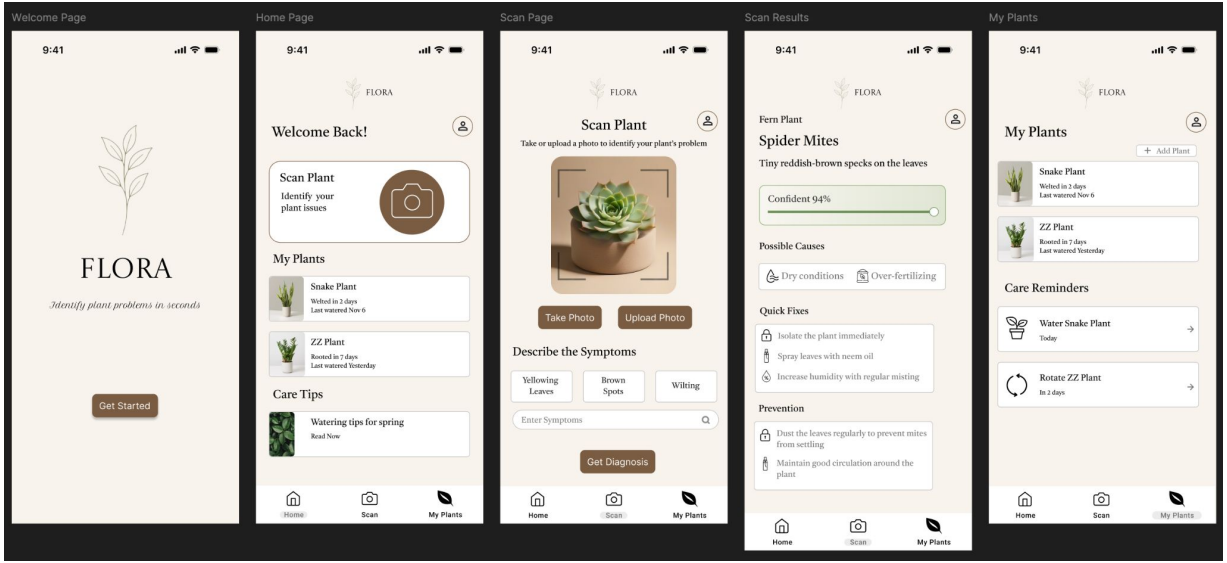


Refining the design

- High-fidelity prototype
- Accessibility

High-fidelity prototype

The full app flow was refined with final visuals, consistent typography, and a cohesive earthy colour palette across all screens.



Google

Accessibility considerations

1

Color Contrast
The dark text on the light beige background ensures text is easy to read for users with visual impairments. The brown button also stands out clearly against the background, making actions easy to identify.

2

Clear Navigation
The bottom navigation bar uses both icons and labels, helping users with cognitive difficulties understand where each tab leads. This reduces confusion and makes moving through the app straightforward.

3

Simple Layout
Each screen focuses on one task at a time with minimal elements, making it easier for all users to process the information. This is especially helpful for users with attention or cognitive challenges.

Going forward

- Takeaways

Takeaways

Impact:

Flora addresses a genuine gap: most plant apps focus on identification, not ongoing care. By combining photo-based diagnosis with a personal plant tracker and care reminders, Flora gives users one place to go instead of juggling Google searches and generic advice.

What I learned:

The user journey maps were the most valuable exercise in this project. Mapping Elena's and Alejandro's emotional states throughout their day made it clear that the app needed to feel effortless at low-energy moments, which directly shaped decisions like the symptom selector and quick-check feature.